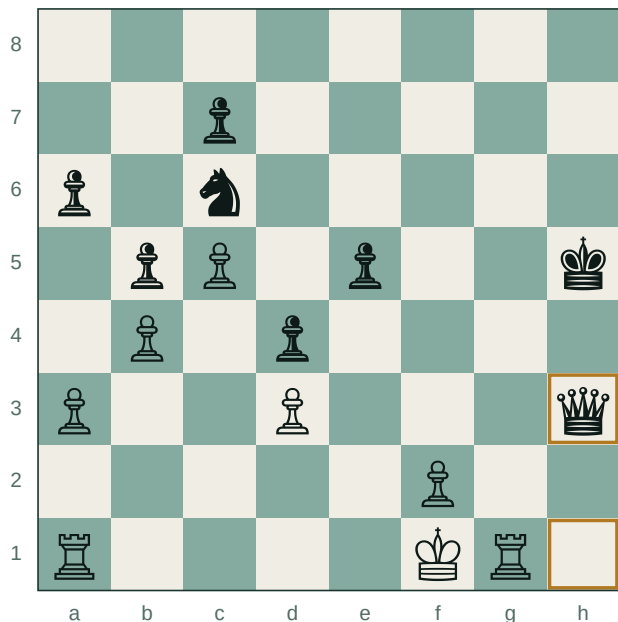


Active defensive resources: White, move 35

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 34...Qxh3+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

35. Ke2 e4 36. Rh1 exd3+ 37. Kd2

35.Ke2 The king moves from f1 to e2. Recorded reply: **35...e4**.

36.Rh1 The rook moves from g1 to h1. Recorded reply: **36...exd3+**.

37.Kd2 The king moves from e2 to d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -2 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on h5. Geometrically undefended: knight on c6 and queen on h3. Check for tactical protection.